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MONDAY

FEBRUARY 23, 2026
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AFP

SPECTACULAR FINISH TO UAE TOUR CYCLING EVENT

■ Lidl-Trek's Italian rider Jonathan Milan (centre) crosses the finish line to win the seventh and final stage of the UAE Tour cycling event from Zayed National Museum to Abu Dhabi Breakwater in Abu Dhabi yesterday. UAE Team Emirates' Mexican rider Isaac Del Toro won two stages of the race and clinched overall victory in the UAE Tour.

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PROPERTY

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IFTAR 18:21

Fajr	05:30	Shuruq	06:44
Dhuhr	12:35	Asr	15:51
Maghrib	18:21	Isha	19:35

IMSAK 05:20

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

UAE, Arab nations slam US envoy's statements

HUCKABEE'S CLAIM OVER ISRAEL'S BORDERS DRAWS IRE

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

More than a dozen Arab and Islamic countries, joined by three major regional organisations, have issued a joint condemnation of remarks attributed to the United States Ambassador to Israel, warning that the comments risk inflaming regional tensions and undermining international law.

A joint statement released by the UAE, Egypt, Jordan, Indonesia, Pakistan, Turkey, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Kuwait, Oman, Bahrain, Lebanon, Syria and the State of Palestine expressed "strong condemnation and profound concern" over comments by the US diplomat suggesting it would be acceptable for Israel to exercise control over territories belonging to Arab states, including the occupied West Bank.

Flagrant violation

The joint statement was also endorsed by the secretariats of the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation (OIC), the League of Arab States (LAS), and the Gulf



The ministries reaffirmed that Israel has no sovereignty whatsoever over the Occupied Palestinian Territory or any other occupied Arab lands."

Joint statement

Cooperation Council (GCC), underscoring broad regional alignment on the issue. The Ministries of Foreign Affairs, according to WAM, described the remarks as "dangerous and inflammatory," arguing that they constitute a "flagrant violation of the principles of international law and the Charter of the United Nations," while posing a "grave threat" to regional security and stability.

The diplomatic reaction follows comments made by US Ambassador Mike Huckabee during an appearance on the podcast of American commentator Tucker Carlson. During the interview, Carlson pressed Huckabee on interpretations of a biblical verse sometimes cited by religious

nationalists as justifying expansive territorial claims for Israel stretching from the Nile to the Euphrates, media reports said.

Responding to the hypothetical scenario, Huckabee said: "It would be fine if they took it all," later characterising the remark as "somewhat of a hyperbolic statement" and emphasising that Israel was "not asking to take all of that." Despite that clarification, the comments drew swift criticism across the Middle East.

Firm rejection

The Arab and Islamic signatories firmly rejected any suggestion of Israeli sovereignty over occupied territories. "The ministries reaffirmed that Israel has no sovereignty whatsoever over the Occupied Palestinian Territory or any other occupied Arab lands," the statement said, reiterating opposition to any attempts to annex the West Bank or separate it from the Gaza Strip. Notably, the declaration framed the controversy as inconsistent with Washington's stated diplomatic goals. They argued that statements perceived as endorsing territorial expansion "constitute incitement rather than advancing peace."



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